

Nasal Allergies (Hay Fever) - Female (Adult)

Algorithm 1218 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- Hay fever / nasal allergy assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published when-to-get-help guidance.
- Adult patient.
- Female.

Initial assessment

1. [OPEN_TEXT] What is the person's exact age and sex, are they pregnant/breastfeeding, immunocompromised, asthmatic, or in a safety-critical driving/aviation role, and how long have symptoms lasted? Confirm no anaphylaxis, serious asthma, infection, eye pain, or visual change.
2. [YES_NO] Have pharmacy treatments been tried?
3. [YES_NO] Any breathing difficulty or wheeze?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Anaphylaxis

Are throat or tongue swelling, breathing difficulty, faintness, confusion, or collapse the main concern?

Systemic allergic-reaction features require the Anaphylaxis pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Is there sudden swelling of the lips, mouth, throat, or tongue, or severe difficulty breathing?

Universal emergency rule-out added ahead of the hay fever guidance itself - typical hay fever does not cause airway swelling or severe breathing difficulty, so these signs suggest a different, more serious allergic reaction.

1. Disposition level 50

Are symptoms getting worse, or have pharmacy medicines not improved them?

NHS.UK guidance: see a doctor if symptoms are worsening or pharmacy treatments haven't helped - may be referred for immunotherapy.

1. Disposition level 15

Is this typical hay fever with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance: a pharmacist can recommend antihistamines and steroid nasal sprays for typical hay fever.

Advice

Qatar emergency allergy response

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive for lip/mouth/throat/tongue swelling, breathing/swallowing difficulty, faintness, confusion, floppiness, or collapse. Use the person's prescribed adrenaline auto-injector immediately according to its instructions and emergency plan; antihistamine must not delay adrenaline or 999. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: breathing or swallowing worsens; swelling spreads; faintness, floppiness, confusion, or collapse.

Routine hay fever follow-up

- Book a clinical review through a Qatar pathway approved by governance (GOVERNANCE_REQUIRED) if symptoms worsen or pharmacy treatments aren't helping.
- Call Back If: symptoms significantly worsen.

Governed hay-fever care

- Reduce pollen exposure with closed windows when counts are high, shower/change after outdoor exposure, and use wraparound glasses. Antihistamine, eye-drop, and nasal-spray selection/dose require age/weight, pregnancy/breastfeeding, asthma, glaucoma/urinary/cardiac conditions, sedation and driving/aviation duties, technique, and current-medicine checks under the approved Qatar pathway.
- Call Back If: symptoms worsen despite treatment; wheeze, asthma deterioration, facial swelling, eye pain, or visual change.

First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive for lip/mouth/throat/tongue swelling, breathing/swallowing difficulty, faintness, confusion, floppiness, or collapse. Use the person's prescribed adrenaline auto-injector immediately according to its instructions and emergency plan; antihistamine must not delay adrenaline or 999. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Hay fever", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/hay-fever/> (page last reviewed 21 March 2024)

Provenance

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